Tableau Data Analyst - Practice Exam 3

Salesforce Certified Tableau Data Analyst (Analytics-DA-201) | Challenging mock - LOD & calculation intensive | Answer key is a separate file - do not peek!

Questions	60 (54 multiple-choice + 6 multi-select) - mirrors the 60 scored items of the real exam
Time	105 minutes recommended (real exam: 105 min, ~90 sec/question)
Pass mark	65% in the real exam = aim for 39+/60 here (self-check bands in the answer key)
Emphasis	Heavy on LOD expressions, calculated fields and table calculations (Domain 2 core), per your request
Rules	Multi-select items say [SELECT 2] - exactly that many; no partial credit, like the real exam

Domain	Weight	Questions	Focus in this paper
Domain 1 - Connect to & Transform Data	24%	Q1-Q14	Live/extracts, joins vs. relationships vs. blends, unions, Prep cleaning & pivots, field customisation
Domain 2 - Explore & Analyze Data (LODs & Calculations Intensive)	41%	Q15-Q39	LODs (FIXED/INCLUDE/EXCLUDE/nested), date/string/logical/aggregate calcs, table calcs, filters, parameters, sets, maps, bins
Domain 3 - Create Content	26%	Q40-Q55	Chart construction & marks, sorting, dashboards, containers, device layouts, all action types, DZV, sheet swap, formatting
Domain 4 - Publish & Manage Content on Tableau Server / Cloud	9%	Q56-Q60	Publishing, schedules, alerts, subscriptions, site roles

Answer every question (unanswered = wrong in the real exam). Flag hard ones and revisit - the real exam allows it.

Domain 1 - Connect to & Transform Data - 24% of exam - Q1-Q14

Q1. A bank's fraud team wants a wall-mounted dashboard that always reflects the current state of suspicious transactions stored in a SQL Server database. Every time the view refreshes, the database itself must be queried. Which connection type should the analyst choose?

A. A live connection to the database
B. A published data source saved as an extract
C. An extract with an incremental refresh every hour
D. An extract with a daily full refresh

Q2. An orders extract holds 40 million rows covering five years, and a full refresh takes three hours - too long for the nightly maintenance window. The source system only appends new rows; historical rows are never updated. What should the analyst configure so refreshes finish quickly?

A. Convert the extract to a live connection with a data source filter
B. An incremental refresh based on Order Date, so only new rows are added
C. Five separate yearly extracts combined with a union in Tableau Desktop
D. An aggregated extract that rolls sales up to the month level

Q3. An analyst connects to an Excel file that contains a merged company title row, notes under the headers, blank spacer rows, and two sub-tables pasted inside the same sheet. Which Tableau Desktop feature detects the real tables and removes this extraneous information?

A. Custom SQL
B. Wildcard union
C. Data source filter
D. Data Interpreter

Q4. You have an Orders table (one row per order, including Shipping Cost) and an Order_Items table (many rows per order). The business wants both tables available to every sheet, combined only when needed, and SUM([Shipping Cost]) must not be inflated by the one-to-many match. Which combining method should you choose in Tableau Desktop?

A. Inner join on Order ID
B. Data blending on Order ID
C. Union of the two tables
D. A relationship between the two logical tables

Q5. You physically join an Orders table to a Returns table on Order ID. The result must contain every order, including orders that were never returned (with null return columns). Which join type do you need?

A. Right join (Returns on the right)
B. Inner join
C. Left join (Orders on the left)
D. Full outer join

Q6. Twelve monthly CSV exports with identical column structures sit in a folder and must be analysed as one table. Next month's file should be picked up automatically when it is dropped into the same folder. Which TWO statements are correct? [SELECT 2]

A. A union stacks the rows of the files one after another into a single table
B. A union requires a common key field, like a join does
C. Each monthly file becomes its own set of columns in the result
D. A wildcard union in Tableau Desktop automatically includes new files that match the search pattern

Q7. Regional sales targets are maintained in a published data source on Tableau Cloud, while transaction-level sales live in a local Excel extract. The two cannot be joined row-by-row (different sources, different grains), and targets must be combined with sales after each side is aggregated to the region level. Which technique should you use?

A. Data blending, with sales as the primary source
B. A union
C. A cross-database join inside the Excel connection
D. A relationship between the two sources

Q8. In Tableau Prep, a Customer_Name field contains values like 'Cathy', 'Kathy', and 'Kathie', which are pronounced the same but spelled differently. Which Group Values option will cluster these names together automatically?

A. Common Characters
B. Spelling
C. Trim Spaces
D. Pronunciation

Q9. A planning spreadsheet is 'wide': one row per product and twelve separate measure columns (Jan_Sales ... Dec_Sales). In Tableau Prep you must reshape it into rows of Product, Month, and Sales for easy analysis. Which step accomplishes this?

A. Join step with a scaffold table
B. Aggregate step
C. Clean step with a custom split
D. Pivot step - pivot columns to rows

Q10. A compliance rule states that no analyst may see rows for discontinued products anywhere in a workbook with eight worksheets - not on any current sheet, nor on any sheet added later. Where should the filter be applied?

A. As a context filter on the busiest sheet
B. As a data source filter
C. As a table calculation filter
D. As a dimension quick filter repeated on each sheet

Q11. A State dimension member 'CA' must display as 'California' in every view, while the underlying column in the database must stay untouched. What should the analyst create in Tableau Desktop?

A. An alias
B. A group
C. A calculated field: IF [State]='CA' THEN 'California' END
D. A set

Q12. You drag YEAR([Order Date]) to Columns and get four separate blue header pills (2021, 2022, 2023, 2024); your line chart appears as four disconnected segments. You need one continuous time axis with a single unbroken line. What should you do?

A. Move the pill to the Pages shelf
B. Right-click the pill and convert the field to Continuous
C. Change the field's data type to String
D. Add the date field to context

Q13. A workbook was built and fully formatted against a test SQL Server database. The production database has an identical schema. All sheets, calculated fields, and formatting must be preserved while pointing the workbook at production. What is the correct approach?

A. Use Data > Replace Data Source and connect to the production database
B. Rebuild the workbook against production
C. Publish the test data source and rename it 'Production'
D. Edit every sheet's fields one by one

Q14. A cleaning flow in Tableau Prep is finished. The result must be emailed to an external vendor who owns no Tableau software and will load the file into their own tool. Which output type is appropriate?

A. A database table in your company's warehouse
B. Published data source on Tableau Cloud
C. .csv file
D. .hyper extract file

Domain 2 - Explore & Analyze Data (LODs & Calculations Intensive) - 41% of exam - Q15-Q39

Q15. You need each customer's lifetime sales as a reusable row-level value - for example, to bucket customers into segments - and the value must stay correct no matter which dimensions are later dragged into the view. Which calculated field delivers this?

A. WINDOW_SUM(SUM([Sales]))
B. TOTAL(SUM([Sales]))
C. {FIXED [Customer ID] : SUM([Sales])}
D. {INCLUDE [Customer ID] : SUM([Sales])}

Q16. A {FIXED [Region] : SUM([Sales])} calculation is used on a sheet. Which TWO kinds of filters will change the values this FIXED LOD returns? [SELECT 2]

A. Context filters
B. Extract filters applied when the extract was built
C. Standard dimension quick filters on the Filters shelf
D. Table calculation filters

Q17. A view shows one row per Region. Management wants, for each region, the average of the state-level sales totals within that region (first total each state's sales, then average those totals). Which expression is correct?

A. AVG({INCLUDE [State] : SUM([Sales])})
B. AVG({FIXED [Region] : SUM([Sales])})
C. AVG({EXCLUDE [State] : SUM([Sales])})
D. WINDOW_AVG(SUM([Sales])) computed Table (down)

Q18. A view lists Sub-Category rows (within Category) showing SUM([Sales]). On the same rows you also need the sales total of the whole parent Category, so each sub-category can be compared to its category total. Which calculation returns the category total on every sub-category row?

A. LOOKUP(SUM([Sales]), FIRST())
B. {FIXED [Sub-Category] : SUM([Sales])}
C. {INCLUDE [Category] : SUM([Sales])}
D. {EXCLUDE [Sub-Category] : SUM([Sales])}

Q19. What does the calculated field {FIXED : SUM([Sales])} - written with braces but no dimension - return when placed on any sheet?

A. Each row's own sales value
B. The grand total of sales for the entire data set, repeated as the same value on every row
C. A running total of sales down the table
D. An error: a LOD expression requires at least one dimension

Q20. A sheet contains {FIXED [Region] : SUM([Sales])}. A user unticks 'Furniture' in a Category quick filter, but the LOD values stubbornly stay the same. Why, and what is the fix so the LOD responds to the Category selection?

A. Change the LOD to EXCLUDE, which always respects dimension filters
B. Move the Category filter to the Pages shelf so it runs earlier
C. FIXED LODs never respond to any filter - rewrite it as a table calculation
D. FIXED LODs ignore standard dimension filters; right-click the Category filter and 'Add to Context'

Q21. Examine this nested LOD:
{FIXED [Region] : MAX({FIXED [Region], [State] : SUM([Sales])})}
What does it compute?

A. For each region, the sales of its best-performing state (the maximum of that region's state totals)
B. The SUM of sales for each region
C. The maximum of all regional grand totals combined
D. The largest single row-level sales value in the data set

Q22. You must create 'Days to Ship' as the number of whole days between the order and the shipment, and understand what a negative value means. Which formula is correct, and what does a negative result indicate?

A. DATEDIFF([Ship Date], [Order Date], 'day') - negative means shipping was fast
B. DATEDIFF('day', [Ship Date], [Order Date]) - positive means shipped before ordering
C. [Ship Date] - [Order Date] - negative means the order was cancelled
D. DATEDIFF('day', [Order Date], [Ship Date]) - negative means the ship date is before the order date

Q23. A view needs a text column that reads 'August', 'September', ... for labelling a report. Which function returns the month name as a string, rather than the number 8, 9, ...?

A. DATENAME('month', [Order Date])
B. DATETRUNC('month', [Order Date])
C. MONTH([Order Date])
D. DATEPART('month', [Order Date])

Q24. A CSV column [Ship Date Text] holds dates like '15/08/2024' (day-first), which Tableau imported as strings. Working with an extract, which expression converts them to real dates?

A. STR([Ship Date Text])
B. MAKEDATE('dd', 'MM', 'yyyy')
C. DATE([Ship Date Text])
D. DATEPARSE('dd/MM/yyyy', [Ship Date Text])

Q25. For Order ID 'CA-2024-115842' you need only the final three characters: '842'. Which expression is correct?

A. RIGHT(3, [Order ID])
B. RIGHT([Order ID], 3)
C. MID([Order ID], 3)
D. LEFT([Order ID], 3)

Q26. A calculated field applies INT() to a margin measure. What does INT(-4.9) return in Tableau?

A. -5
B. 4
C. -4
D. 5

Q27. Which TWO statements about Tableau's logical functions are true? [SELECT 2]

A. CASE tests one expression for equality against each listed WHEN value
B. CASE can evaluate ranges, e.g. WHEN [Sales] > 1000 THEN 'Big'
C. IF ... ELSEIF ... END can evaluate range conditions such as SUM([Sales]) >= 10000
D. IIF is guaranteed to return only numeric results

Q28. Some rows have NULL Profit. For an average computation, the business wants those nulls treated as 0 rather than being skipped. Which is the simplest expression to wrap [Profit] with?

A. ZN([Profit])
B. NULL([Profit])
C. ATTR([Profit])
D. ISNULL([Profit])

Q29. An orders table has one row per order line. Management asks: 'How many different customers placed at least one order?' Which aggregation answers this correctly?

A. ATTR([Customer ID])
B. COUNTD([Customer ID])
C. MAX([Customer ID])
D. COUNT([Customer ID])

Q30. Order IDs look like 'CA-2024-115842' (Region-Year-Number). You need the year token '2024' as its own field. Which expression is correct?

A. SPLIT([Order ID], '-', 2)
B. LEFT([Order ID], 2)
C. SPLIT([Order ID], '-', 3)
D. MID([Order ID], '-', 2)

Q31. A month-over-month change calculation reads:
SUM([Sales]) - LOOKUP(SUM([Sales]), -1)
In a continuous-month view computed Table (across), what does LOOKUP(SUM([Sales]), -1) return for each month?

A. Sales of the first month of the data set
B. The average sales of all months
C. Sales of the last month in the partition
D. Sales of the previous mark (the previous month) in the partition

Q32. A crosstab has Region on Rows and continuous MONTH(Order Date) on Columns. A 3-month moving average of sales must accumulate across the year but restart at the first month of each region instead of bleeding across regions. Which 'Compute Using' setting achieves this?

A. Table (down)
B. Specific Dimensions > Region only
C. Table (across)
D. Cell

Q33. States are ranked by SUM([Sales]) descending. Two states tie for second place. The business wants the ranking 1, 2, 2, 3 - tied states share a rank and no rank numbers are skipped. Which function should the calculated field use?

A. RANK_DENSE(SUM([Sales]), 'desc')
B. INDEX()
C. RANK_UNIQUE(SUM([Sales]), 'desc')
D. RANK(SUM([Sales]), 'desc')

Q34. You place a table-calculation-based field (e.g., 'Rank <= 3') on the Filters shelf to show only the top 3 states. Which statement about the '% of Total' values still visible is TRUE?

A. Table calculation filters execute before dimension filters in the pipeline
B. Hidden states are removed from the data, so % of Total is recalculated against the top 3 only
C. Table calculation filters merely hide marks; the hidden states remain in the computation, so % of Total is still relative to all states
D. Tableau does not allow filtering on table calculations

Q35. A view should show the Top 10 products by sales within the Technology category only. The analyst adds a Top 10 'by field' filter on Product Name and a Category = Technology quick filter - but the result shows only the Technology products that happen to be in the company's overall top 10. How do you get the top 10 *of Technology*?

A. Replace the filters with an EXCLUDE LOD
B. Right-click the Category filter and select 'Add to Context', then keep the Top 10 filter
C. Sort descending and manually hide everything ranked 11+
D. Convert the Top 10 filter into a table calculation filter

Q36. Sales managers want an on-screen control to set a quarterly revenue target that appears as a horizontal reference line on a bar chart, updating live as they type or drag. What is the correct implementation?

A. Use a quick filter on Sales pinned to the target
B. Create a numeric parameter, show its parameter control, and set the reference line's Value to that parameter
C. Create a set from the target value and add it to Colour
D. Create a reference line with a constant value and re-type it each quarter

Q37. Which TWO statements about sets in Tableau are true? [SELECT 2]

A. A combined set can be configured to return the members shared by two existing sets
B. A set defined by a condition or a Top N rule is dynamic - its membership re-evaluates when data refreshes
C. A set writes new rows back into the underlying data source
D. Sets can only be created by manually selecting marks and stay constant forever

Q38. On a map of thousands of customer geocoded points, overlapping circles visually merge into blobs. Stakeholders want a smooth colour gradient showing concentration of customers - hot zones glowing where points overlap most densely. Which map type best serves this?

A. Density map
B. Heat map with square marks in a crosstab
C. Filled map (choropleth)
D. Symbol map with larger marks

Q39. An operations team wants a histogram of order values where the bucket width (e.g., $50, $100, $250) can be changed by report consumers without editing the workbook. Which approach delivers this?

A. Write a FIXED LOD that buckets orders by customer
B. Create a manual group of [Sales] values
C. Create bins on [Sales] and set 'Size of bins' to be driven by a parameter
D. Create a set on [Sales] with a Top N condition

Domain 3 - Create Content - 26% of exam - Q40-Q55

Q40. A sheet shows monthly sales bars and a line for monthly budget (both in currency). After choosing Dual Axis, the two measures use different scales, making the comparison misleading. Which step aligns them?

A. Move one measure to the Pages shelf
B. Add the budget field to context
C. Right-click the secondary axis and select 'Synchronize Axis'
D. Convert both pills to discrete

Q41. Given fields Item (dimension) and Revenue (measure), how should you configure the marks card to produce a standard pie chart of revenue share per item?

A. Item to Colour, Item to Label, Revenue to Angle
B. Revenue to Colour, Revenue to Label, Item to Detail
C. Item to Size, Item to Label, Revenue to Detail
D. Revenue to Colour, Item to Label, Item to Angle

Q42. You need to see the distribution of order values - how many orders fall into each value range. Which is the correct way to build this in Tableau Desktop?

A. Drop [Sales] on Colour and Customer on Rows
B. Select the continuous measure [Sales] and choose Histogram from Show Me (Tableau creates equal-size bins)
C. Create a pie chart with Sales on Angle
D. Add a trend line over [Sales] by Category

Q43. A project plan table lists tasks with [Start Date] and [Duration Days]. To build a timeline where each task is a horizontal bar starting at its start date and stretching for its duration, which configuration is correct?

A. Start Date on Filters, Task on Text
B. Start Date (continuous, exact date) on Columns, Task on Rows, mark type Gantt Bar, Duration on Size
C. Start Date and Duration both on Rows as discrete headers
D. Duration on Columns, Task on Colour, mark type Circle

Q44. Using Tableau's default box-and-whisker plot, how far do the whiskers extend?

A. Always to the absolute minimum and maximum values
B. Exactly one standard deviation above and below the mean
C. Fixed at the 5th and 95th percentiles
D. To the most extreme data points within 1.5 times the interquartile range (IQR) of the hinges

Q45. A bar chart shows Category and Sub-Category on Rows with sales bars. Sorting Sub-Category descending by sales currently reorders sub-categories globally, so 'Chairs' pushes other categories around. The business wants sub-categories sorted by sales independently inside each Category. What should you use?

A. Manual sort of sub-category headers
B. A nested sort: right-click Sub-Category > Sort > Sort By Field = Sales (nested)
C. Alphabetical sort on Category
D. A quick table calculation sorted Table (down)

Q46. A dashboard needs a right-hand column holding several filters and a legend that must resize together cleanly as the window size changes. Which layout approach is correct?

A. Fixing absolute pixel positions for each object
B. Floating each filter object over the dashboard
C. Adding many Blank objects at random positions
D. Placing the objects in a vertical layout container (tiled)

Q47. Your executive dashboard must also be usable on phones. Which statement about device layouts in Tableau Desktop is TRUE?

A. Changing the default dashboard never affects any device layout
B. Phone users automatically get a perfect layout with no action by the author
C. You build phone support via Dashboard > Device Preview, then 'Add Phone Layout', arranging a phone-specific layout alongside the default
D. Device layouts require publishing first and are configured only on Tableau Server

Q48. From a state-level sales bar chart, clicking a state should make its cities stand out on a companion map while all other cities stay visible (dimmed), not disappear. Which interactivity should you configure?

A. A set action
B. A highlight action
C. A filter action
D. A URL action

Q49. Executives want to click any customers on a scatter plot to assemble a comparison group; chosen customers should recolour as 'Selected' everywhere on the dashboard, and a summary sheet should compare the selected group against everyone else. Which action type powers this?

A. A parameter action
B. A highlight action
C. A Go to Sheet action
D. A set action that toggles membership of a Customers set

Q50. Clicking a year on a small chart should instantly update a Year Threshold value used by several calculated fields and a reference line across the dashboard. Clicking once must write that year into the shared input. Which feature does this?

A. A context filter on year
B. A data source filter on year
C. A parameter action writing the clicked year into a parameter
D. A set action

Q51. Which TWO statements about Dynamic Zone Visibility are true? [SELECT 2]

A. When a tiled object is hidden this way, the space it occupied is reclaimed and neighbouring objects shift to fill it
B. It works only on Text objects
C. An object's visibility can be controlled by a boolean field or a boolean parameter via Layout > 'Control visibility using value'
D. The feature works only on floating objects

Q52. Stakeholders want a single drop-down to switch one dashboard zone between a Sales view, a Profit view, and a Returns view, each occupying the same space. What is the classic implementation?

A. A combined set placed on Colour
B. Three separate dashboards linked with URL actions
C. A string parameter + a calculated filter field compared to the parameter on each sheet, all sheets stacked in one container with titles hidden
D. The Pages shelf with a year field

Q53. Hovering over a state on a sales map should reveal a small monthly trend line chart for that state inside the tooltip itself. Which feature provides this?

A. Viz in Tooltip (Insert > Sheets in the tooltip editor)
B. A mark annotation
C. A reference band
D. A dashboard URL action

Q54. The company's brand palette must appear as a selectable custom colour palette in the 'Edit Colors' dialog of every workbook you open on your machine. How do you register it with Tableau?

A. Add the palette XML to Preferences.tps in your My Tableau Repository folder
B. Edit the workbook's .twb and Tableau will remember it globally
C. Upload the palette to Tableau Cloud
D. Save a file called colors.json into the Program Files install directory

Q55. An analyst must present findings as a guided, ordered walkthrough: each step keeps its own frozen view state and a written caption explaining the insight. Which Tableau construct fits best?

A. A story with story points and captions
B. A worksheet with many annotations
C. A single dashboard with floating text boxes
D. A packaged workbook of exported images

Domain 4 - Publish & Manage Content on Tableau Server / Cloud - 9% of exam - Q56-Q60

Q56. A central data team maintains one governed 'Sales' model. Thirty analysts must build workbooks from it, and nobody should ever be prompted for the database password. What is the best publishing approach?

A. Email everyone a .tds file each month
B. Publish the data source to Tableau Server/Cloud and embed the database credentials (optionally certifying it)
C. Publish with 'prompt user' authentication
D. Place a .hyper file on a shared network drive

Q57. A published extract on Tableau Server feeds the morning sales dashboard. The source database gains new rows overnight and historical rows never change. A full refresh of all history is too slow. What should be scheduled?

A. An incremental extract refresh on the server schedule, keyed on Order Date
B. A subscription
C. A full extract refresh every hour
D. A data-driven alert

Q58. The VP of Operations must receive an email the moment the daily returns measure on a published dashboard exceeds 500 units - and only in that situation. What should the analyst set up?

A. A highlight action on the returns chart
B. A subscription to the dashboard every morning
C. An incremental extract refresh
D. A data-driven alert on the returns view with a threshold of 500

Q59. Which TWO statements about subscriptions on Tableau Server/Cloud are true? [SELECT 2]

A. A subscription fires only when a measure crosses a threshold
B. A subscription emails an image (and optionally PDF) of a view or workbook to recipients on a defined schedule
C. A subscription refreshes the workbook's extract when it sends
D. Users can subscribe themselves to views they have permission to see, and users with the right permissions can subscribe others

Q60. A business user needs to: interact with published dashboards, drill and edit existing workbooks in the browser and save copies, but she will never need to connect to a new external database or author content from raw sources. Which site role is the minimum appropriate choice?

A. Viewer
B. Explorer
C. Creator
D. Site Administrator